

SOUL WORD ANALYSIS CARD

Framework B — Spirit, Soul and Body Research Programme

Phase 1 Individual Word Analysis

SECTION 1 — WORD IDENTITY

WORD	GRIEF
DATE ANALYSED	04/03/2026
REGISTRY NO.	72 of 181
SOURCE LIST	✓ High Confidence
BIBLICAL PRESENCE	✓ Strong — pervasive across all genres. One of the largest vocabulary clusters in the 181: 24+ terms across Hebrew and Greek (see Section 2). Grief is the dominant affective register of Lamentations, the Psalms of Complaint, and the Suffering Servant texts. Critical cross-card link with anger (4): Mark 3:5 established that orge and lupe are co-present in holy anger. This card analyses that connection in depth.
POLARITY	✓ Dual-valence — grief as appropriate response to genuine loss (positive/healthy) and grief as debilitating soul-state (negative/pathological). 2 Cor 7:10 is the key distinguishing text: godly grief (kata theon lupe) vs. worldly grief (tou kosmou lupe). This is the most precise biblical typology of grief in the NT.
DATA NOTE	STEP export: exceptionally rich — 24 Hebrew/Greek terms. This is among the highest vocabulary counts in the 181 so far (alongside shame at 30 terms). Full coverage confirmed; no gaps flagged.

SECTION 2 — LINGUISTIC DATA

Hebrew Terms (selected primary roots)

Term	Transliteration	Gloss	Key References
יָגוֹן	yagon	sorrow, grief — inner pain	Gen 42:38; Psa 13:2; 31:10; 116:3; Jer 8:18; 20:18; 31:13 — STEP sourced
אָוַל / אָוֵל	aval / avel	to mourn, mourning — outward expression	Gen 37:34,35; 2Sa 13:37; 19:1; Ezr 10:6; Neh 1:4; Isa 61:2,3 — STEP sourced
מָרַר	marar	to be bitter, grieved — intensity of suffering	Psalm 120; 1Sa 1:10; Job 3:20; Lam 1:4 — STEP sourced
תִּגַּח	tugah	sorrow, grief — heaviness of spirit	Psa 119:28; Pro 10:1; 17:21 — STEP sourced
אָוֵן	oni	affliction, suffering — grief as social condition	Gen 41:11; 29:32; 31:42; 41:52; Exo 3:17; Deu 16:3; 26:7; Psa 31:7 — STEP sourced
כָּעַב / מָכַח	keev / makhov	pain, sorrow — physical-emotional	Job 1:6; Psa 39:2; Isa 17:11; 53:3,4; Jer 15:18; 30:15 — STEP sourced
אָטָו	atsav	to grieve, hurt — including God being grieved	Gen 6:6,9; Isa 54:6; 63:10; Eph 4:30 parallel — STEP sourced
יָגַח	yagah	to suffer, to be in anguish	Lam 1:4,5,12; 3:32,33; Zep 3:18 — STEP sourced

Greek Terms

Term	Transliteration	Gloss	Key References
λύπη	lupe	grief, sorrow, pain — the core NT term	1Th 1:6; 2Th 1:4; Rom 9:2; 2Cor 2:1,3,7; 7:10; 9:7; Phi 2:27; 1Pe 2:19 — STEP sourced
λυπέω	lupeo	to grieve, to cause sorrow (verb)	Mat 14:9; 17:23; 19:22; 26:22,37; Joh 21:17; Rom 14:15; 2Cor 2:2,4,5; Eph 4:3
πένθος	penthos	mourning, grief — especially at death	Mat 5:4; Rev 18:7,8,11; 21:4 — STEP sourced
πενθεύω	pentheo	to mourn (verb)	Mat 5:4; 9:15; Mar 16:10; 1Cor 5:2; 2Cor 12:21; Jam 4:9; Rev 18:11,15,19 — STEP sourced
στενάζω	stenazo	to groan — grief expressed as inner turmoil	Mat 26:75; Rom 8:23; 2Cor 5:2,4; Heb 13:17; Jam 5:9 — STEP sourced

■δ■vn	odune	pain, anguish — sharp grief (also in Targum-cSTEP sourced	in Targum-cSTEP
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SECTION 3 — DIMENSION TAGS

Biblical / Theological	✓ Affective/Lament ✓ Covenantal (grief over sin, exile, loss of presence) ✓ Christological (Isa 53:3 — man of sorrows; Matt 26:37 — Jesus sorrowful/troubled) ✓ Pneumatological (Eph 4:30 — grieving the Holy Spirit) ✓ Eschatological (Rev 21:4 — no more grief)
Soul Faculty	✓ Affective (primary — grief as core emotional experience) ✓ Relational (grief at loss) ✓ Moral-conscience (godly grief — grief over sin; co-present with holy anger — Mar 3:5) ✓ Volitional (choosing whether to grieve appropriately or to suppress)
Psychological	✓ Loss response ✓ Attachment disruption ✓ Moral emotion (godly grief) ✓ Regulation (grieving vs. suppression) ✓ Transformative (2Cor 7:10 — grief producing repentance) ✓ Anticipatory (grief before loss — Joh 16:6)
Neurological	✓ Anterior cingulate (grief and pain overlap — social pain hypothesis) ✓ Amygdala (loss and threat response) ✓ HPA-axis (chronic grief = cortisol dysregulation) ✓ Default mode network (rumination in grief) ✓ Insula (pain processing — keev/makhov bodily pain)
Social / Relational	✓ Other-directed (grief at another's suffering — Rom 9:2; Phi 2:27) ✓ God-directed (grief over sin — Psa 31:9; Ezr 10:6) ✓ Communal (national lament — Lamentations) ✓ Pneumatological (grieving the Spirit — Eph 4:30; Isa 63:10)

SECTION 4 — SEMANTIC RANGE

Grief has the largest vocabulary count of any word analysed so far — 24+ terms — which signals that it is among the most anthropologically significant experiences in the biblical world-view. The data suggests grief occupies a structural position in the soul's life that is neither purely negative nor optional: it is the appropriate response of a soul that loves, that is attached to others, and that has a moral conscience. The Hebrew vocabulary covers a wide range from inner pain (yagon — sorrow held within the self) to public mourning (aval — the enacted, visible mourning with torn garments and ashes) to physical-emotional overlap (keev/makhov — pain that is simultaneously bodily and psychological; see Isa 53:3,4 where these terms describe the Servant's suffering). The atsav root is the most theologically startling: it is used of God being grieved — Gen 6:6 (it grieved him to his heart) and Isa 63:10 (they grieved his Holy Spirit), with the identical root appearing in Eph 4:30 (do not grieve the Holy Spirit). This is not coincidental: the Spirit's grief-capacity is the NT continuation of a well-established OT theme. Grief is a divine experience before it is a human one. The Greek lupe/lupeo cluster is the dominant NT grief vocabulary and is uniquely rich. Second Corinthians 7:10 introduces the most precise typology in the entire grief data: kata theon lupe (grief according to God — godly grief) vs. tou kosmou lupe (worldly grief). Godly grief produces metanoia (repentance, transformation) and leads to salvation without regret; worldly grief produces death. The distinction is not in the intensity of grief but in its object and direction: godly grief is grief over sin/alienation from God and others; worldly grief is grief over loss of earthly goods, status, or comfort — it turns inward and stagnates rather than turning toward God and transforming. The stenazo (groaning) vocabulary adds a further dimension: grief that cannot be fully articulated and is expressed as inner groaning. Romans 8:23 is the defining text — creation groans, we groan inwardly in longing for redemption. This is grief as eschatological tension: the soul, indwelt by the Spirit, grieves the gap between the present age and the age to come. This is not pathological grief — it is the healthy, Spirit-formed response to living between-the-times. Penthos (mourning) appears in the Second Beatitude (Matt 5:4 — blessed are those who mourn), linking grief directly to blessedness. The mourners who are comforted are those who grieve over the state of the world/self as seen from God's perspective — which connects penthos to the godly-grief typology of 2 Cor 7:10. In both cases, grief is the faculty of the soul that correctly perceives the gap between what is and what should be.

SECTION 5 — KEY VERSES

VERSE 1	2 Corinthians 7:10
Text	"For godly grief (kata theon lupe) produces a repentance that leads to salvation without regret, whereas worldly grief (tou kosmou lupe) produces death."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Moral-conscience ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	The NT's most precise diagnostic text on grief. Introduces a binary typology — godly vs. worldly grief — distinguished not by intensity but by direction and outcome. Godly grief produces metanoia (deep transformation); worldly grief produces thanatos (death).
Direction	✓ God-directed (godly grief turns toward God) ✓ Self-directed (both forms)
Observation	This verse is the primary Framework B tool from the grief vocabulary. The godly/worldly distinction maps directly onto the three-state typology: (1) Functioning — godly grief, properly directed, producing transformation; (2) Disabled — no grief at all, the soul anaesthetised to loss and sin; (3) Inverted/worldly — grief turned inward and producing death rather than transformation. 2 Cor 7:10 also confirms that grief is a moral faculty, not merely an emotion: it is the soul's response to what matters morally.
VERSE 2	Mark 3:5 (cross-reference)
Text	"And he looked around at them with anger (orge), grieved (sullupei) at their hardness of heart."
Context Type	✓ Christological ✓ Moral-conscience ✓ Relational
Human Impact	The co-presence of anger and grief in Jesus at the Pharisees' hardness of heart. Sullupei is a strengthened form of lupe — to be deeply grieved together with, or intensely. This is the definitive cross-card link between anger (4) and grief (72): in holy anger, grief is always present.
Direction	✓ Other-directed (grief at another's hardness) ✓ God-directed (grief as moral perception)
Observation	The anger card flagged this verse as requiring cross-card analysis. The finding: holy anger and grief are not competing emotions but two faces of the same moral response. Anger is the energy that refuses to be passive; grief is the sorrow that proves the anger arises from love, not contempt. Together they constitute the full moral-emotional response of a soul that deeply cares about what is being violated. Framework B must treat anger and grief as a functional pair within the moral-conscience faculty.
VERSE 3	Isaiah 53:3–4
Text	"He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows (makhov), and acquainted with grief (choli — sickness/grief); and as one from whom men hide their faces... Surely he has borne our griefs (choli) and carried our sorrows (makhov)."
Context Type	✓ Christological ✓ Prophetic ✓ Atonement
Human Impact	The Servant is defined by grief as a characteristic — not a passing experience but an identity. Makhov (pain/sorrow) and choli (sickness/grief) describe the full weight of human suffering carried by the Servant. The bearing and carrying language is substitutionary.
Direction	✓ Other-directed (bearing our grief) ✓ God-directed (in obedience to the Father's will)
Observation	This is the atonement text for grief: the Servant takes our griefs and sorrows into himself. This has direct implications for Framework B's treatment of grief in pastoral and psychological contexts: grief is not a problem to be solved but a weight that has been borne by the one who identified fully with human suffering. The Incarnation is the divine entry into human grief — the grief is taken, not dismissed.

VERSE 4	Ephesians 4:30
Text	"And do not grieve (lupeo) the Holy Spirit of God, by whom you were sealed for the day of redemption."
Context Type	✓ Pneumatological ✓ Moral ✓ Covenantal
Human Impact	The Spirit has a grief-faculty. The command is to not grieve him — implying that human sin and the behaviours of vv.25–31 (lying, anger unresolved, stealing, corrupt speech, bitterness) produce grief in the Spirit who indwells the community. This is a direct echo of Isa 63:10.
Direction	✓ God-directed (Spirit as the one grieved)
Observation	Eph 4:30 is the NT's most explicit statement that God experiences grief through the Spirit. This confirms and extends the atsav/Gen 6:6 data: grief is not foreign to the divine nature but characteristic of a God who is in covenantal relationship and who cares deeply about what happens within that relationship. Framework B implication: the soul's grief-faculty is imago Dei — a capacity that reflects the divine capacity for grief as a response to violation of relationship. Cross-reference with the forgiveness project: the Spirit's grief is the starting point for the forgiveness process.
VERSE 5	John 16:20–22
Text	"You will weep and lament...you will be sorrowful, but your sorrow (lupe) will turn into joy. When a woman is giving birth, she has sorrow (lupe) because her hour has come, but when she has delivered the baby, she no longer remembers the anguish, for joy."
Context Type	✓ Christological (pre-Passion teaching) ✓ Eschatological ✓ Relational
Human Impact	Jesus frames the disciples' coming grief (at the crucifixion) as birth-labour: intense, purposive suffering that produces new life. The grief is real — he does not minimise it — but it is "pregnant" grief: it carries the promise of transformation and joy.
Direction	✓ Other-directed (grief at the loss of Jesus's presence) ✓ God-directed (in faith)
Observation	The birth-labour metaphor is among the most theologically significant grief images in the NT. It maps directly onto 2 Cor 7:10 (godly grief producing salvation): grief is not an end-state but a process with a trajectory. This is the grief that the soul is designed to pass through, not to avoid. The neurological parallel: the acute stress response is designed for resolution; chronic, unresolved grief produces the pathological cortisol dysregulation because the process is arrested before completion.
VERSE 6	Matthew 5:4
Text	"Blessed are those who mourn (penthountes), for they shall be comforted."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom/Beatitude ✓ Eschatological ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	Grief as the condition of blessedness. Those who mourn in the context of the Beatitudes are those who grieve over the state of the world as God sees it — the poor in spirit (v.3) and the mourners share the same fundamental soul-orientation: accurate perception of reality before God. The comfort (paraklesis) promised is divine consolation.
Direction	✓ God-directed (grief from God's perspective) ✓ Eschatological (comfort to come)
Observation	Matthew 5:4 is the Beatitude that most directly validates grief as a spiritually healthy state. The mourner is not pitied or told to cheer up — they are declared blessed. This is a radical re-valuation: the culture around Jesus (Roman honour culture) valued self-sufficiency and composure; Jesus inverts this by making grief a mark of the kingdom. Framework B: grief is not a dysfunction to be treated but in its godly form a sign of moral and spiritual health.

VERSE 7	Romans 8:23
Text	"And not only the creation, but we ourselves, who have the firstfruits of the Spirit, groan (stenazo) inwardly as we wait eagerly for adoption as sons, the redemption of our bodies."
Context Type	✓ Eschatological ✓ Pneumatological ✓ Christological
Human Impact	The Spirit-indwelt soul groans with creation in eschatological longing. This is grief-as-tension: the soul that has tasted the firstfruits of redemption necessarily grieves the incompleteness of the present age. The groan (stenazo) is not despair — it is pregnant with hope (v.24).
Direction	✓ God-directed (longing for final redemption) ✓ Communal (we ourselves — corporate)
Observation	Romans 8:23 establishes that eschatological grief is normative for the believer. The soul that does not groan is either not yet Spirit-indwelt or has become acclimatised to the present age. This is the between-the-times grief that cannot be resolved by pastoral care or psychological technique — it is a structural feature of Christian existence. Framework B: grief and hope (elpis) are bound together by the Spirit; grief without hope is worldly grief (2 Cor 7:10); hope without grief is triumphalism.

VERSE 8	Psalms 31:9–10
Text	"Be gracious to me, O Lord, for I am in distress; my eye is wasted from grief (ka'as); my soul and my body also. For my life is spent with sorrow (yagon), and my years with sighing."
Context Type	✓ Lament ✓ Individual-internal ✓ Bodily-somatic
Human Impact	The somatic signature of grief: the eye wasting away, the soul and body both affected. Grief does not stay in the soul — it moves into the body. The whole person grieves: eye, soul (nephesh), and body together. This is the Psalter's consistent pattern: grief is holistic, not compartmentalised.
Direction	✓ God-directed (lament addressed to God) ✓ Self-directed (the griever's own condition)
Observation	Psalms 31:9–10 provides the empirical foundation for Framework B's psychosomatic integration: grief has a bodily dimension. The eye-wasting (ophthalmos atimatai) is consistent with the documented psychophysiology of grief: elevated cortisol, immune suppression, cardiovascular changes, physical exhaustion. The biblical writers were describing what they observed. Cross-reference with the DNA/epigenetic dimension: chronic grief-stress is among the most documented epigenetic pathways (NR3C1 methylation — shared with shame Card 146).

SECTION 6 — SOUL FUNCTION IN FRAMEWORK B

Soul Faculty Engaged	<i>Affective (primary — grief as core emotional experience), Moral-conscience (godly grief as moral-emotional response to sin and relational violation), Relational (grief at another's suffering), Volitional (whether to grieve appropriately or to suppress/deny), Pneumatological (the Spirit grieves; the believer's grief is Spirit-formed).</i>
Framework B Contribution	<i>Grief occupies a unique structural position: it is the soul's appropriate response to loss — which means it is a sign of the soul correctly valuing what it has. A soul incapable of grief is a soul incapable of love. The godly/worldly distinction (2 Cor 7:10) is the central Framework B tool: it positions grief not as a problem but as a faculty with two forms — one that transforms (toward God) and one that destroys (turned inward on the self). The Spirit's grief-capacity (Eph 4:30) grounds the human faculty in the divine.</i>

Regenerate Expression	Godly grief: grief directed toward God over sin and the state of the world; grief over the suffering of others that moves toward intercession and action (Rom 9:2 — Paul's unceasing anguish for Israel); eschatological groaning with hope (Rom 8:23); the mourning of Matt 5:4 that is already declared blessed. The regenerate soul can receive comfort (Isa 61:3 — beauty for ashes) because it has first genuinely grieved.
Unregenerate Expression	Three states: (1) Functioning — appropriate grief at genuine loss (common grace); (2) Disabled — the soul anaesthetised to grief: no mourning over sin, no sorrow at another's suffering (Amo 6:6 — not grieved over the ruin of Joseph; Jer 5:3 — struck down but felt no anguish); (3) Inverted/worldly — grief turned inward, producing death rather than transformation (2 Cor 7:10b). The disabled state may be more dangerous than the inverted state: it is the soul that has lost the faculty entirely.
Cross-Card Links	Anger (4): holy anger and grief co-present in Mar 3:5 — they are a functional pair in the moral-conscience faculty. Anguish (this session): grief and anguish share vocabulary and soul-space — grief is the response to loss; anguish is the intensification of that response under extreme circumstances. Shame (146): chronic shame-stress shares the epigenetic pathway (NR3C1 methylation) with chronic grief-stress. Forgiveness (65): the Spirit's grief (Eph 4:30) is the starting point for forgiveness — God grieves before he forgives, which grounds the human process.

SECTION 7 — NEUROSCIENCE & PSYCHOLOGY

Psychological Framework	Grief is among the most researched human experiences. Kübler-Ross stages (denial, anger, bargaining, depression, acceptance) are widely known but empirically contested — grief does not follow linear stages. More accurate: oscillation model (Stroebe & Schut 1999) — griever oscillates between loss-orientation and restoration-orientation. 2 Cor 7:10 maps onto this: godly grief moves toward restoration-orientation (transformation); worldly grief is locked in loss-orientation (death). The distinction is directional, not a difference in the grief experience itself.
Brain Regions	Anterior cingulate cortex (ACC) and insula activate in grief — same regions as physical pain (social pain hypothesis, Eisenberger & Lieberman 2004). This provides the neurological foundation for the biblical vocabulary's overlap between grief and bodily pain (keev/makhov in Psa 31:9–10; Isa 53:3–4). Amygdala: threat/loss response. Default mode network: rumination in prolonged grief. Reward circuits: disrupted — loss of the presence of the loved object produces dopamine withdrawal (O'Connor et al. 2008).
Psychophysiology	Cortisol elevation (HPA-axis), immune suppression, cardiovascular stress, sleep disruption. Chronic unresolved grief produces the same physiological profile as chronic stress — the process is arrested, the body remains in the acute stress state. The Psa 31:9–10 somatic description (eye wasting, soul and body affected) is consistent with documented psychophysiology.
Epigenetic Dimension	✓ High confidence — shared pathway with shame (Card 146). Chronic grief-stress produces NR3C1 methylation (glucocorticoid receptor gene — stress response regulation). Prolonged childhood grief (loss, abandonment) produces measurable epigenetic changes that affect stress reactivity in adult offspring. The OT pattern of generational mourning (Lam 5:7 — "our fathers sinned...we bear their iniquities") is consistent with epigenetic inheritance of grief-stress responses. This makes grief the second strongest epigenetic candidate in the 181 alongside shame.

SECTION 8 — OPEN QUESTIONS & FLAGS

1. GRIEF-ANGER FUNCTIONAL PAIR CONFIRMED: The Mark 3:5 analysis (anger card) is confirmed and extended. Holy anger always carries grief; grief at sin/injustice is inseparable from the anger that refuses to be passive. These two faculties together constitute the moral-emotional response of the soul that deeply cares. Framework B synthesis flag: anger (4) and grief (72) should be treated as a functional pair within the moral-conscience cluster. 2. DIVINE GRIEF TRAJECTORY (Gen 6:6 → Isa 63:10 → Eph 4:30): The Spirit's grief-capacity is one of the most neglected pneumatological themes in the NT. The trajectory from Gen 6:6 (God grieved to his heart at human sin) through Isa 63:10 (they grieved his Holy Spirit) to Eph 4:30 (do not grieve the Spirit) establishes grief as a consistent attribute of God in covenantal relationship. Framework B must account for this: grief is imago Dei before it is human. 3. GODLY GRIEF AS TRANSFORMATIVE MECHANISM: 2 Cor 7:10 identifies godly grief as the mechanism of metanoia (repentance/transformation). This connects grief directly to the forgiveness project: genuine repentance requires genuine grief over sin. The therapeutic shortcut of bypassing grief to reach forgiveness produces the incomplete transformation Paul diagnoses in worldly grief. Practical implication: grief is not a problem to be resolved but a process to be completed. 4. VOCABULARY SCALE: The 24+ term vocabulary for grief — the largest or second largest in the 181 — signals that the biblical world-view treats grief as a rich, differentiated experience requiring fine-grained description. Modern psychological culture tends to treat grief as a problem to be managed or overcome. The vocabulary itself is a corrective: grief has many forms, textures, and purposes, and the soul needs the vocabulary to navigate them. Framework B should preserve this richness rather than reducing grief to a single category. 5. ANGUISH OVERLAP: The grief and anguish files share vocabulary (odune, stenazo, ka'as). Framework B should distinguish: grief = the soul's response to loss/sin/suffering (structural); anguish = the intensification of grief under extreme or overwhelming circumstances (acute). They are on the same continuum, not two different faculties.